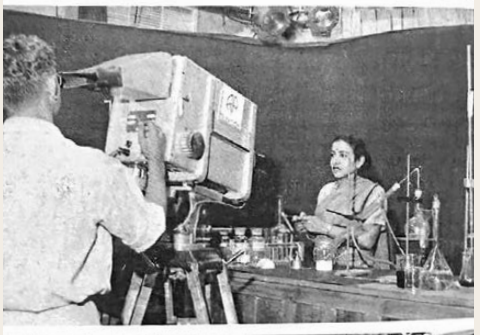
INDIA TODAY ARCHIVES











NEW-AGE SYMPHONY Clockwise from right, the Doordarshan logo; a children's drama, a science show and a folk programme being recorded in a Doordarshan studio; the cast of the first drama series in Hindi, the immensely popular soap, *Hum Log (1984-85)*; facing page, a clutch of advertisements for colour TVs

TELEVISION

THE COLOURFUL ENTRY OF THE SMALL SCREEN

In television, 1982 was the watershed year: the start of both a unified, national DD network as well as colour broadcasts. Soon, *Hum Log* enraptured a national audience

Although television was introduced in India in the 1950s, it remained in a nascent state until the Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) deployed SITE (Satellite Instructional Television Experiment) in collaboration with NASA in 1975. Until then, TV was only being broadcast in seven Indian cities. Now it was reaching deep into the rural heartland. SITE eventually evolved into the indigenous INSAT (Indian National Satellite System) programme. National telecast was introduced in 1982, as well as colour transmission, just in time for the Asian Games. Doordarshan was the only television channel in those days (India has over 900 channels now).